



88% of Dubai urban areas covered by public buses

DUBAI
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Dubai Roads and Transport Authority's (RTA) drive to expand the use of smart systems and artificial intelligence in the public bus service has enhanced the efficiency of Dubai's mass transit network. It has improved operational performance, reduced costs, ensured better adherence to schedules, and elevated customer satisfaction. The bus service now covers about 88 per cent of the emirate, with a fleet of 1,390 buses completing 11,000 daily trips and covering approximately 333,000 kilometres. This year, RTA will implement a plan to expand dedicated bus and taxi lanes, adding six new lanes spanning 13 kilometres. With this expansion, the total length of dedicated lanes would reach 20 kilometres. The expansion is expected to increase passenger numbers by 10 per cent, improve bus arrival times by 42 per cent and reduce journey times by 41 per cent, according to Mattar Al Tayer, Director-General, Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of Dubai's RTA.

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OVER 950 CHILDREN KILLED BY ISRAELI AIRSTRIKES IN THE LAST TWO MONTHS

GAZA

The United Nations Children's Fund (Unicef) has warned that the Gaza Strip has become the most dangerous place in the world for children, with no safe areas remaining, following the deaths of over 45 Palestinian children in the past two days alone amid ongoing Israeli attacks. Edouard Beigbeder, Unicef Regional Director for the Middle East and North Africa, stated that children are being targeted in locations that should be safe such as hospitals, schools, shelters and even displacement tents. He stressed that over the past 19 months, Gaza has become increasingly deadly for children. Beigbeder revealed that more than 950 Palestinian children have been killed by airstrikes in the last two months, while those who remain face severe hardships, including relentless bombardment, extreme shortages of food, water and basic health care. He added that the blockade on humanitarian aid is worsening the crisis, noting that the dangers to children extend beyond bombs and bullets to include hunger, disease and contaminated water. Beigbeder emphasised that violations of children's rights have become systematic



A Palestinian woman carries an injured child outside Al Shifa hospital in Gaza City yesterday. AFP

and daily occurrences, calling for urgent international action to end these abuses and ensure the protection of children from violence and loss of life. 103 killed Israeli strikes across the Gaza Strip killed at least 103 people overnight and into yesterday, hospitals and medics said, and

prompted the main hospital in northern Gaza to close. Open to a deal Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu signalled that Israel was open to a deal with Hamas that would include "ending the fighting" in Gaza, laying out conditions for such an agreement. "Even at this very mo-

ment, the negotiation team in Doha is working to exhaust every possibility for a deal — whether according to the Witkoff framework or as part of ending the fighting, which would include the release of all the hostages, the exile of Hamas terrorists, and the disarmament of the Gaza Strip," his office said. — Agencies

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